

BABATUNDE Abdullahi Olanrewaju

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PERSONAL STATEMENT

I am a doctoral researcher in Strategic Management at the Africa Business School, Mohammed VI Polytechnic University, examining how organizations emerge, grow, and sustain themselves within informal and market systems. My work draws on deep ethnographic fieldwork, grounded qualitative analysis, experimental designs, and theory-building to explain mechanisms of competition building, apprenticeship-based capacity development, and market resilience, particularly within Indigenous African business system. I am committed to producing rigorous scholarship that advances theoretical debates while offering insights for policymakers, entrepreneurs, and communities navigating informal economies.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Invisible Growth: How Firms Expand through Informal Institutions in African Markets.

- Conducting ethnographic research to investigate how informal apprenticeship systems shape firm growth, knowledge transfer, and cooperative competition across Nigerian trading clusters.
- Employing participant observation, in-depth interviews, and archival mapping to capture the social mechanisms and institutional logics that underpin competition and market resilience.
- Contributing to theory development on firm growth and organizing by integrating insights from strategic management, organization theory, and indigenous knowledge systems.

From Competitor Response to Competitor Production: Stewarded Competition in an Indigenous Market System.

- Utilized a qualitative approach to explore how intentional competition building fosters a collaborative ecosystem in fragmented markets.
- Investigated strategies for mutual growth, focusing on non-zero-sum dynamics where competition benefits all participants.
- Provided actionable insights into business models that promote sustainability and resilience in competitive environments.

Management Control in Informal Economic Settings

- Investigating how coordination, accountability, trust, and performance monitoring are achieved in informal market environments where formal managerial controls are largely absent.
- Examining the role of social norms, apprenticeship structures, reputation mechanisms, and community-based sanctions as alternative control systems within indigenous business networks.
- Exploring how informal control mechanisms influence entrepreneurial development, business continuity, cooperation, and market resilience.
- Contributing to emerging debates on management control systems in non-Western and institutionally complex contexts.

Knowledge Transfer & Knowledge Capsule: Criteria for Successful Farming in Indigenous Communities

- Explored how tacit and explicit knowledge transfer among farmers drives productivity and sustainability in indigenous farming communities.
- Conducted mixed-method research, incorporating qualitative interviews and quantitative analysis of farming outcomes.
- Highlighted the role of elder farmers as knowledge capsules and emphasized collaboration as a critical success factor in agricultural practices.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Africa Business School, UM6P: Teaching Assistant. July 2026 - Oct 2026

- Supported the delivery of sustainability-focused modules for EMBA students, including case analysis and ESG-aligned strategy frameworks.
- Guided student teams in applying Sustainability Balanced Scorecards, Strategy Maps, and Causal Loop Diagrams to selected case studies.
- Assisted with the design of marking rubrics, grading, and facilitation of interactive sessions that emphasized responsible management and strategic leadership in global contexts.
- Assisted with the collection and preparation of data for use cases, ensuring that teaching materials reflected current sustainability practices in real-world organizations.

Africa Business School, UM6P: Teaching Assistant. May 2025 - Aug 2025

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Mimbar Schools, Bodija, Ibadan: Mathematics Teacher. Nov 2022 - Aug 2023

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The Noble Standard Schools, Ayegun-Olomi, Ibadan: Vice Principal. Apr 2018 - Oct 2020

- Acted as a liaison between students, parents, and school administration, addressing concerns and providing guidance on academic, cultural, and administrative matters.
- Spearheaded the promotion of cultural exchange programs, fostering cross-cultural understanding among students through events, workshops, and extracurricular activities.
- Played a pivotal role in student affairs management, ensuring the overall well-being and discipline of students within the school.
- Collaborated with teachers and staff to create a nurturing and inclusive environment that supports the academic and personal growth of all students, regardless of their cultural background.
- Mentored and guided student leaders, empowering them to take on leadership roles and initiate projects that benefit the broader student community.

EDUCATION

2023 - present	PhD (Strategic Management): Africa Business School, UM6P, Rabat, Morocco.
2020 - 2022	Master's Degree in Collective Intelligence: Mohammed VI Polytechnic University, BenGuerir Morocco. (GPA: 15.24/20.0)
2012 - 2016	Bachelor's Degree in Mathematics Education: Ekiti State University, Ado-Ekiti, Nigeria. (GPA: 4.38/5.0)
2007 - 2010	Senior Secondary Certificate Examination: Wesley College of Science, Elekuro, Ibadan, Nigeria.

PRESENTATIONS & CONFERENCE

From Competitor Response to Competitor Production: Stewarded Competition in an Indigenous Market System.

Strategic Management Society (SMS), October 2026

Invisible Growth: How Firms Expand through Informal Institutions in African Markets.

Strategy, Entrepreneurship, and Innovation (SEI) Research Day, UCL School of Management, January 2026

Bayes Research Day, Bayes Business School, London, February 2026.

Beyond the Zero-Sum Game: Deliberate Competition Building in Fragmented Markets.

Academy of Management (AOM)PDW at The America University in Cairo, December 2025

INFORMS Annual Conference, October 2025

Mohammed VI Polytechnic University Doctoral Days, October 2025.

PUBLICATIONS

Babatunde, A.O. & Boehe D.M. "From Competitor Response to Competitor Production: Stewarded Competition in an Indigenous Market System." *Status: In review at Org Sci.*

Babatunde, A.O. & Tim W. "Control Without the State: How Management Control is Exercised and Reproduced in Informal Settings" *Status: Paper submission stage.*

Babatunde, A.O. & Boehe D.M. "Market Practices and Social Impact in Informal Trade Clusters: A Quasi-Experimental Study." *Status: Research design and data collection stage.*

SKILLS

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- Proficient in using Microsoft Excel, R, and Python (Pandas, Matplotlib) for quantitative analysis, data cleaning, and visualization.
- Skilled in SPSS and NVivo for qualitative and quantitative data management, coding, and interpretation.
- Experienced in handling structured datasets and maintaining digital archives for research projects.
- Experienced in using Zoom, Microsoft Teams, Slack, Trello, and Miro Board for virtual collaboration, project coordination, and real-time feedback.
- Competent in using collaborative tools (Google Workspace, Mendeley, Zotero, LaTeX, and MS Office Suite) for academic writing, referencing, and document management.

PERSONAL SKILLS

- Proven ability to work effectively in interdisciplinary and cross-cultural teams, mentoring students, coordinating research tasks, and supporting collective academic goals.
- Skilled at synthesizing complex qualitative and quantitative data to generate actionable insights.
- Strong capability to articulate research ideas clearly through writing, teaching, and conference presentations, ensuring both academic rigor and practical relevance.

AWARDS

- 2026: Nominated for PhD Paper Prize Award: **Strategic Management Society.**
- 2026: Robert Faff Pitching Award: **African champion and finalist in the global competition.** (1100 cash prize)
- 2026: Visiting PhD Scholar **Imperial College Business School, London, United Kingdom.**
- 2026: Global Development Fellowship: **Imperial College Business School, London, United Kingdom.**
- 2025: Robert Faff Pitching Award: **Africa Business School, UM6P, Rabat, Morocco.** (300 cash prize)
- 2020: Ibn Rochd Foundation Scholar: **Mohammed VI Polytechnic University, BenGuerir Morocco.**
- 2015: Best Tutor Award, Department of Mathematics: **Government Day Secondary School, Durbawa.**
- 2015: Best Graduating Student, Department of Mathematics: **Ekiti State University, Ado-Ekiti, Nigeria.**
- 2013: Overall Best Student in 2001, Department of Mathematics: **Ekiti State University, Ado-Ekiti, Nigeria.**

LEADERSHIP

Organization for Youth Empowerment Nigeria (OYEN): Co-founder. Nov 2013 - Till date

- Managing communications, including correspondence, reports, and meeting minutes, ensuring effective information flow between the NGO, students, parents, and school authorities.
- Coordinating logistics for educational programs and events, from planning to execution, ensuring smooth operations and positive outcomes.
- Promoting the NGO's initiatives at regional and international forums, sharing insights and best practices for supporting students in underprivileged communities.

National Youth Service Corps Durbawa, Sokoto: Zonal Coordinator. Nov 2016 - Oct 2017

- Facilitated cultural exchange programs and partnerships with international organizations, creating opportunities for corps members to engage in global dialogue and collaborative projects.
- Initiated and led community service projects in collaboration with corps members, promoting community development and addressing local needs.

VOLUNTEER ACTIVITIES

- Note taker at the COP 30 Global Citizen Assembly.
- Africademics Ambassador for the year 2022
- Country Ambassador, UM6P School of Collective Intelligence
- Moderator at Hotspot International Student Forum. (2020 – till date).
- Note taker at the COP 28 Global Citizen Assembly.

- Participant at the Plant It Forward program of 2021. Planting 2000 olive trees in BenGuerir, Morocco.

EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

- UM6P Inter School Football Tournament — 1st Place Winner 2025.
- UM6P Inter School Football Tournament — 1st Place Winner 2024.
- UM6P Rabat Campus Mini CAN — 1st Place Winner 2024.
- Marathon Medalist, representing — 2024
- Best Football Male Player in the Mini CAN — 2023.
- UM6P Rabat Campus Mini CAN — 1st Place Winner 2023.
- Ping-Pong Gold Medalist UM6P Ramadan Tournament 2023.

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIP

- Member: Strategic Management Society
- Emerging fellow: Interdisciplinary Network for Technology and Entrepreneurship Research in Africa (INTERA)
- Member: Teachers Registration Council of Nigeria (TRCN)

REFERENCES

- Available on Request